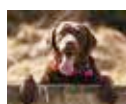




Satellites to save Sharks

According to a research, satellites in orbit could help curtail overfishing of sharks in certain areas of the ocean. <https://digit.in/nov18-42-1>



Dog colour matters

A research reveals that chocolate Labradors live significantly shorter lives than their black and golden cousins. <https://digit.in/nov18-42-2>



Time for a new tracker

Agent001 feels like it's time he upgraded to a dedicated fitness tracker. Here's how he went about picking his next gizmo.

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cross my many travels across the globe, one thing that's quite evident in most first world countries

is the prevalence of fitness trackers among the people. Head to the US or Singapore and you'll find practically everyone wearing a smart band or a fitness tracker. If you hang around the water cooler to catch up on some gossip, then you're definitely going to be part of a conversation around these trackers. The conversation generally turns into a pissing contest of sorts with everyone waxing on about how they clocked 300 kilometers last month or are halfway towards hitting the million-step milestone. That isn't the case back home in India. Or rather, that wasn't the case. With more brands bringing their fitness gadgets into the market, we're slowly catching onto the trend. So while I have owned a smartwatch since the first Moto 360 hit the market, I haven't been a religious user. Which is why I decided to make the most of this moment and get myself a decent fitness tracker.

Since I've had the Moto360 for a long time, it has undergone quite a bit of wear and tear, and it shows. So I might as well get a new tracker and check out some of the new features

that current gen fitness trackers ship with. So what are my needs? A good quality strap, one that's not only durable but is also not going to cause a rash after prolonged periods of time. We're talking about a 36-hour stretch here, and not more than that. Wearing or using any device that long is



never recommended. Not that fitness trackers would end up making you do something outrageous, such as getting you to exercise. Jokes aside, if you wear a strap for that long then the sweat and oil accumulating under the strap can result in a nasty rash. Natural rubber

seems to be the best choice here since it is not only hypoallergenic but feels good to touch as well.

Then comes the device itself. A simple and time-tested form-factor is the classic watch design. It not only acts as a tracker but also has a screen to tell the time. I'm not too finicky about the watch face being analog or digital. Either is fine, and if the manufacturer allows you to switch between the two or pick a custom watch face, then that's fine as well. What I don't like is having to dismantle the tracker each time I have to charge it. So, anything that makes something as simple as charging into a cumbersome process is off my books.

The tracker should allow me to pick different activities and have a pretty good accuracy for the sensors. After all, it is a "tracker" and what good would it be if it doesn't have accurate enough sensors to do the primary job that's expected of it. Since we're on the topic of sensors, one of the sensors most pertinent to my favourite activity i.e. running is the GPS. A lot of the fitness trackers in the market do have GPS functionality, however, the tracker relies on your phone to obtain GPS data. Take your phone out of the equation and your accuracy goes for a toss. Moreover, running with a heavy phone dangling around in your pocket isn't something I look forward to. So the tracker must